

PROJECT PACK

Entry Points • Artistic Statement • Structural Cosmology

How I Wrote a book at 6
AND PROOFREAD IT AT 8

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A lifetime of masking.

1. PROJECT AT A GLANCE

Form	A one-person story carried by two bodies on stage: the speaking performer (moving between Maksio and Masking M) and a silent Black Figure.
Core premise	A lifetime arc encoded in the title: creation at 6 (the handmade book) and correction at 8 (the red pen, self-surveillance, the pressure to become legible).
Runtime	Approx. 50–60 minutes, no interval.
Scale	One speaking performer and one silent onstage figure. Minimal set: desk, chair, book, red pen, with light and sound functioning as the primary scenographic language. Designed for black-box / studio touring, but scalable without changing the core dramaturgy.
Languages	Bilingual Polish / English. Polish carries body, home and first-logic; English carries system, performance and correction.
Dramaturgy	Built like a score: rhythm, repetition, interruption and patterned breakdown carry meaning alongside text.
Audience contract	The piece works through recognition rather than explanation. Midway through, that contract shifts: when the vocative is returned from the auditorium, the audience becomes implicated as addressee.
Key ending move	No curtain call. Exactly 72 seconds of silence. The audience is lit as the final image, turning spectatorship itself into part of the ending.
Repeat viewing	The first viewing lands through story, rhythm and recognition. A second viewing makes the pattern-score and reversals more legible, re-framing earlier scenes. Repeat viewing is not required, but it changes the work.

2. KEY DRAMATURGICAL MOVES

The play masks itself: It presents as a feelings-heavy autobiographical solo show while a structural argument moves underneath. The emotional surface is not separate from the hidden form; it is part of the same logic. The play's mathematical, linguistic and rhythmic grammar is not decorative – it is how the piece thinks. What any spectator reaches first depends on attention, experience and the particular frequency they are already tuned to – not on any fixed category.

Prologue as overture of symbols: The world appears before it can be explained: book, desk, chair, jacket, medals, red pen. Meaning is not delivered in advance; it emerges through recurrence. The room first behaves as responsive rather than judgemental.

Two bodies, one human architecture: The Black Figure is not atmosphere, diagnosis-symbol or rescuer. The figure makes visible the split between performing self and witnessing self, between what is enacted and what remains beside, behind or outside that enactment.

Wołacz as hinge: The vocative is interrupted and returned from the auditorium. Address shifts, and with it the audience's position. From that point on, the room is no longer only witnessing the action – it has become structurally implicated in it.

Language as system-pressure: Polish and English do different dramaturgical work. Polish carries first-relation, body-memory and home logic; English carries institutional form, performance and correction. Untranslatability is not a barrier to the piece but one of its methods.

The hand as visible logic: The piece repeatedly locates pressure in the hand: touch, trace, count, grip, tear, release, reach, hold. It is one of the clearest places where curiosity hardens into correction, sensation into procedure, and inner pressure becomes physically legible. Later, the same manual vocabulary reopens into contact, co-regulation and supported return.

Pattern as dramaturgical grammar: Counting, recurrence and formal echo are not quirks or embellishments. They are part of the play's meaning-making

system, reframing obsessive detail as structure and pattern-recognition as a way of carrying feeling.

Systems, not incidents: Bells, footsteps, applause, correction and ritual repetition are not background devices. They are the mechanisms through which the body is trained, read and kept in motion, even after those mechanisms begin to fail.

The ending refuses release: Applause is staged as a structure rather than a reward, and the ending withholds the usual social release of a curtain call. The final silence does not reset the room; it leaves the audience inside its own looking.

Built to loop: The piece is designed as a circular form in which return does not mean reset. A second encounter does not simply repeat the first; it alters the meaning of what has already been seen. The loop is not a reset; it is a renegotiation.

Making intention: The project is neurodivergent-led wherever possible, so that the work's internal logic is held from the inside rather than translated from outside.

3. THE THREE FIGURES AND THEIR RELATIONSHIP

This section introduces the three presences that carry the show's structural and emotional argument. They are not characters in the conventional theatrical sense – they do not develop through plot or arrive at resolution. They are positions: three states of a single human architecture, made simultaneously visible. The drama lies not in their separation alone, but in the relation between them: what each can hold, what each cannot sustain, and what becomes possible only when more than one of them is present.

Maksio (6 letters)

Maksio is not a memory. He is a present-tense inhabitant of a world that runs beneath the masking world simultaneously, always. To describe him as a child who grows up would be to impose the narrative arc of the eight-world onto a being who lives entirely in the six-world. He does not grow up in the piece. He is grown over. Those are different things.

His world is organised around abundance rather than deficit. He receives more signal than most people – clouds have taste, weight and agency; language has a gap between its literal and idiomatic meaning that he discovers with delight; an ant is at once pattern and creature, and its possible lostness matters. This is not hyperactivity or distraction. It is pattern recognition at a first-order perceptual level, before interpretation arrives, producing joy that is always epistemological – the pleasure of a structure closing, a hidden equivalence found, the world briefly making sense in a way that needs to be shared.

His relationship with Mamo is the structural centre of his world. *Mamo* in Polish is not a term for a category of person – it is the vocative case, the grammatical posture of reaching. Maksio turns towards her constantly, not out of dependence but because meaning, for him, is intersubjective: things become fully real when they are shared. He finds the pattern alone, in the counting. But it becomes complete in the telling. This relational structure – meaning as something achieved between people – is what makes the Wołacz scene the hinge it is: the

case of address is the only case he cannot complete, and the gap where it should have been is where the audience becomes the addressee.

His body operates on its own first language: closer to the ground, more physical contact, more weight and touch, following its own internal logic rather than the external requirements of posture and presentation. The Maksio scenes are where the body has not yet learned that it needs to ask permission to be itself. His thinking moves by logic jumps – fast, lateral, analogical moves that follow internal associative paths which are complete and coherent from the inside, but do not proceed in the linear, step-by-step format the school world recognises as valid. These are not mistakes. They are accurate reports from inside a different epistemological order.

He was always going to encounter the red pen. What makes the question of how total that encounter had to be particularly charged is that Maksio is, from the beginning, a natural performer. *Uwaga! uwaga! Zaraz będzie wielkie burzysko!* – this is not a child reporting a meteorological event. It is a child seizing the room, timing the announcement, calibrating the alarm for maximum effect. The reach in *Na mniebo* is also a reach for attention – the pleasure of being looked at while looking up. The hunger to demonstrate, to announce, to be seen in the act of noticing, is native to the six-world. It is one of Maksio's primary joys, and it runs through every scene he is in. *Mamo, look at me* is the show's last line, but it is also, structurally, its first impulse.

This matters because the eight-world does not create the performance instinct. It recruits it. Masking M is built partly from the same material as Maksio's storm announcement – the same capacity to read a room, time a delivery and hold an audience – redeployed in the service of legibility rather than joy. The child who loved to announce storms becomes the adult who can recite a city list with barely a slip. The instrument is the same. The music it is playing has changed. The question the piece keeps open – which it deliberately refuses to close – is whether the masking had to be as complete as it was. Whether the system had to be as indifferent to the question about the ant. Whether the performance instinct, which was always there, had to be taken and turned entirely into a tool for survival, with the joy stripped out in the conversion.

He is still in the show at the end. He has never been successfully masked. He has only been consistently and expensively managed.

Masking M (7+1 = 8)

Masking M is not a villain. He is what went right, by the only available metric, in the only available context: a nervous system that learned to keep itself legible inside systems that were not built for it. He is functional, competent and, by every external measure, successful. The show does not frame this as failure. It frames it as a performance that is failing by one digit, in every list, at the precise point of closest familiarity.

His primary mode of speech is the list: city populations, cloud types, Fibonacci numbers, emotional definitions. The list demonstrates competence without requiring disclosure, performs knowledge without performing self, and is – crucially – completable. A list has an end. Most of the other things in Masking M's life do not close. They loop. The lists are the only things that reliably close. Except: in this show, they do not. Each list carries evidence of what is underneath inside its own formal structure. The self keeps bleeding through the form designed to contain it.

The intrusive rules in Scene 6 – feelings are for weak people, feeling nothing is safety – are not memories of specific incidents of correction. They have become syntax: installed at the level of the sentence, interrupting the fluent definition-speech as if they belong inside it, because after sufficient repetition they do. They were given by people whose care was real, in contexts where the advice was not entirely wrong, to a child who had already sensed that the systems ahead had a lower tolerance for expressiveness than his native level. The rules arrived as assistance. They installed as apparatus. The difference between assistance and apparatus is time.

The medals follow the same logic. Each one represents genuine competence, genuine effort, genuine capacity demonstrated under pressure. The tragedy of the medals is not that they are false. It is that they are awarded for the performance rather than for the person performing it – and that each medal makes the jacket heavier, and that the jacket cannot be removed without also returning the evidence. The world looks at the medals and concludes: he is fine.

After Sisyphus, the body jumps down and cannot rise. This is not symbol. It is the specific depletion that occurs when a nervous system running at sustained high load – monitoring output, pre-empting judgement, managing sensory input while

simultaneously generating legible responses to it – runs out of the resource the performance requires. The bells try to reset the system in Scene 9. The body does not respond. What replenishes it is not rest and not absence of demand: it is the Black Figure entering and sitting behind him, present without asking anything, providing the co-regulation that a depleted nervous system needs in order to begin finding its baseline again.

The name encodes the condition. Masking M is the name that performs the logic it describes: *MASKING* has seven letters; *MASKING M* has eight. The +1 is the name itself – the initial that completes the displacement, that takes the seven-letter act and gives it the letter-count of the world it performs inside. Maksio (six, the child-world) becomes Maks (four, the name of obligation and expectation) becomes Masking M (eight, the performance-world). Not replaced, not destroyed – just moved, just far enough to pass, not far enough for the original shape to disappear. The adjustment is small. The cost of maintaining it, continuously, is the show.

Black Figure (11 letters)

The Black Figure is a structural witness. Not a saviour, not a symbol of autism, not atmosphere – a formal device that makes the split between performing self and witnessing self visible in space. Where Masking M maintains the performance, the Black Figure holds the position of the self that watches the performance happening and registers what it costs. These are not two different people. They are two aspects of a single person – given separate bodies, placed in the same room.

The figure is silent throughout. Its silence is not absence. It is the form available to the part of the person that is not performing: the part that has been tracking what the system cannot absorb or speak back. The silence holds all of that without being able to say any of it, because the system that demands speech does not have a mechanism for this kind of speech.

Its geometry across the show follows its function precisely: it arrives when the performing system fails, and withdraws when the system reasserts. In Scene 9, the bells try to reset and cannot; the figure enters, sits behind, and stays until the footsteps return. In Scene 11, two bodies lie on the floor in parallel, cries settling into

interval, a brief conditional harmony broken by the system's footsteps. Scene 10 is the deliberate anomaly in the mirror logic: the figure arrives where the pattern says it should not, at the point of complete system overload, because it is no longer arriving as a memory of the child-world but as the thing the frozen body cannot produce for itself. Upon touch: a single scream. The overflow that compliance had been suppressing.

The full range of the figure is deliberately withheld. From the first entrance to Scene 13, it operates in restraint – stillness, micro-timing, precise spatial choices, presence that holds focus without claiming it. The final waltz is where the withholding ends: two bodies finding the waltz frame together, the Black Figure staying present through the stim, through the practical support of the shoulder-lift. The Prologue is already waltz-coded – Chopin breath-notes, an oom-pa-pa underneath – and the second body can be read as present there already, integrated inside the performer as rhythm and shared breath, not yet externalised. Scene 14 makes that latent structure visible: what was always there, given a second body.

The final image – the performer on the Black Figure's shoulders, the address made from a height that is supported and shared and genuinely precarious – changes the geometry of the whole show. The opening *mamo* was directed upwards from below: a child's plea towards someone physically and structurally above him. The final *mamo* is made from a borrowed altitude, with another person's stability underneath it, towards an audience that has become the addressee. The address is the same. The terms have changed. The call is no longer made alone.

Is it a tragedy?

The subtitle calls this piece *an autistic mathematical tragedy of words*, and the word *tragedy* is worth holding precisely, because the show does not use it in the classical sense. There is no hamartia, no catastrophic event, no catharsis that cleans the room at the end. What the piece stages is a different kind of tragedy: structural rather than event-based, accumulative rather than sudden. The tragedy is not that something broke. It is that something was continuously, incrementally displaced – by one digit, one letter, one case – for long enough that the displacement became the baseline. The cost is not a single moment. It is the

ongoing arithmetic of maintenance: the effort of remaining one position over from your own position, indefinitely, because the alternative was never clearly survivable.

But the piece qualifies its own word. The loop structure, the Wołacz cards, the 72 seconds of silence with the house lights up, and the music that waits for the stim to settle are not only tragic devices. They are the show's counter-argument to its own subtitle: the insistence that the tragedy is not sealed, that the loop is a renegotiation rather than a reset, that each return to the Prologue arrives carrying the weight of what the audience has witnessed and is therefore not identical to the last. The tragedy is real. So is the word *almost* in *Prawie Wiosna*. The piece lives in the space between them.

4. ENTRY POINTS

Entry point	Core lens
A. Sensory score / nervous system craft	
Entry Point 1 – Waltz for a Nervous System	A sound-led way in: breath–Chopin, nervous system as score, and the shift from co-regulation to pressure, witness and return.
Entry Point 2 – Three Bells Are Enough	Conditioning, ritual signals, glitch and obedience – theatre as behavioural lab.
B. Mythic frame / autobiography / vertical grammar	
Entry Point 3 – The Homeland That Never Existed	Mythical Poland as reconstructed safety image; reverence turning into pressure, and the hiraeth of a corrected self.
Entry Point 4 – The Height Arc	Ground versus height as the play’s vertical spine: ascent, burden, storm–pressure, collapse and supported lift.
C. Relational and perceptual ethics	
Entry Point 5 – Autistic Dialogue, Not Explanation	A recognition-based dramaturgy: ‘Do you also...?’ rather than teaching or diagnosing, carried through bodily dialogue and wordless mirroring.
Entry Point 6 – The Gaze Is the Ending	Ethics of spectatorship: vocative handover, applause as pressure, no curtain call, and the audience as final image.
Entry Point 7 – Look Harder = Notice More	Pattern literacy as a route in: dense callbacks, repeat viewing, opt-in counting, and the pleasure of late legibility.
D. Theatre machinery / tone / formal misalignment	
Entry Point 8 – Systems, Conditioning, Applause Economy	Rooms train bodies; correction passes through the hand; praise becomes contract; applause becomes enforcement.
Entry Point 9 – Laughing Under the Mechanism	Humour as navigation: connection, camouflage, brittle wit – and laughter that darkens into pressure on return.
Entry Point 10 – Almost Right, Then Wrong	Near-patterns, misalignment and glitch–sense: structure felt as affect.

A. Sensory score / nervous system craft

Entry Point 1: Waltz for a Nervous System

Focus: <i>Sound-led entry: co-regulation, breath as melody, masking as rhythm</i>
Key devices: <i>breath-Chopin, pulse, bells/footsteps conditioning, applause swell, Black Figure as witness</i>

This piece is built like a score for a body that learned to survive by pre-correcting itself.

Rather than using music as background, the world behaves like an instrument. Sound and light respond to contact and timing, as if the room is co-regulating rather than evaluating. The Prologue's breath-made Chopin fragments and the deep pulse are not decoration. They establish a rule: rhythm comes before explanation. Before the audience is given a thesis, it is given a tempo. Before meaning is pinned down, the body is already being taught how this world breathes.

That matters because breath is the first music of the piece. The Chopin fragments are not presented in full-bodied pianistic form, but as something partial, human and effortful: melody carried through engineered breath, underwritten by pulse. The effect is intimate rather than ornamental. Sound arrives first as contact, not performance. The room seems to answer the body before it judges it. In that early state, the piece offers a model of regulation that is relational: rhythm as shared ground, not yet command.

From there, the score becomes less secure. Bells and footsteps begin as dependable ritual and later turn unreliable, distorted and harder to escape; what first felt like the room responding can start to feel like the room training. But Act 2 does not reduce the sound-world to coercion. It also introduces child-cries, pauses and moments of fragile harmony that work very differently: not as commands, but as forms of regulation, witness and return. The question is physical rather than metaphorical: why does a body keep obeying a signal it

knows is broken? The second half makes that question audible while also distinguishing pressure from care.

That is why masking here reads less as personality than as rhythm. The play's language is the body: breath, stillness, micro-timings, pacing, heel-lifts, interruptions, resumptions. It is a nervous system negotiating the cost of being visible. What gets staged is not simply emotion, but regulation: the tiny and continuous adjustments through which a person keeps themselves legible in a room that does not reliably meet them halfway.

The Black Figure keeps that split legible. Not only as image, but as score. Where Masking M maintains the performed rhythm, the Black Figure holds another timing: witness, restraint, shadow labour, the body that registers what performance costs. In the middle scenes, this appears as distance, silence, parallel positioning and delayed contact. By the final waltz, it becomes more overtly shared: two bodies finding a common frame, a common pulse, a common way of staying upright inside the music. What was seeded acoustically in the Prologue is made bodily at the end.

This is also why the piece's sound-world matters politically. Co-regulation and evaluation do not sound the same, even when they use similar materials. A responsive pulse can become an imposed rhythm. A cue can become a demand. A room can seem to support a body while simultaneously training it into compliance. The score traces that shift with great precision.

Applause is part of the composition too. After the Sisyphus moment it begins as scattered clapping, then is overtaken by recorded applause until it reads as pressure rather than praise. In sonic terms, the room's approval becomes another wave the body has to survive. What should release tension instead extends it. The piece treats applause not as what comes after the score, but as one of the score's harshest transformations.

The ending holds its nerve. No curtain call, no neat catharsis, no final release into theatre etiquette. What remains is a held silence after sustained pressure: not empty, but resonant. By that point the politics have already become structural. The room is not a neutral observer of disability. It is one of the forces that trains, rewards, corrects and withholds. The play does not merely tell that story. It composes it into breath, pulse, signal and suspension.

Entry Point 2: Three Bells Are Enough

Focus: <i>Signal entry: conditioning, ritual breakdown, obedience to malfunction</i>
Key devices: <i>bells/footsteps, EMOTIONS interruptions, applause as signal</i>

Three bells. That's all it takes to move a body. This entry point treats the piece as a behavioural lab: a room in which sound becomes signal, signal becomes ritual, and ritual becomes something the body obeys before thought has time to catch up. The question is not simply what the bells mean. It is what happens once a learned response persists even when the signal has started to break.

At first, the bells and footsteps operate cleanly. They create a theatrical logic the audience can learn quickly: a cue arrives, the body responds, the system appears legible. But the piece is interested in what survives after legibility fails. By the second half, the signals begin to glitch, arrive wrongly, overlap, or persist beyond their original function. The body, however, keeps obeying. That is the point. Conditioning outlasts clarity. A reflex does not need the world to remain coherent in order to keep firing.

This is why the bell structure matters so much. It is not only a recurring sound motif. It is a mechanism for showing how repetition installs itself in the nervous system. The bells begin as ritual signals and become evidence of training. When the system malfunctions, the body does not simply step outside it and recover some pure autonomy. It continues to respond according to the logic it has learned, even when that logic is no longer trustworthy.

The same principle appears in language. In *EMOTIONS*, explicit feeling words do not arrive as open confession but as definitions, exercises, interruptions and rules. The intrusive statements do not sit outside the fluent speech as commentary; they cut into it as if they belong there. That is what conditioning looks like when it has moved beyond instruction and into syntax. The body is not only being cued from outside anymore. The cue has been internalised into the sentence.

Seen this way, the later collapse of signal is not an exception to the system but its revelation. The clean ritual was never neutral; it was always training. Once the

bells begin to fail, the piece exposes the cost of that training more starkly. The audience is not simply watching a body respond to cues. It is watching what happens when a body has been taught that response is safer than uncertainty, even after the cue itself has become unstable.

Applause belongs here too, but only in this narrower sense: as another signal the body has learned to answer. The piece stages it not as simple reward but as a cue that can become demand, another patterned response that continues under pressure. The room fills with signals; the body keeps reading them. Three bells are enough because, once installed, the mechanism no longer needs much to keep running.

B. Mythic frame / autobiography / vertical grammar

Entry Point 3: The Homeland That Never Existed

Focus: <i>Mythical homeland as safety image; praise/heritage turning into discipline, the hiraeth of a corrected self</i>
Key devices: <i>mythical Poland, Wiosna thread, 'national treasure' as ownership, bilingual texture, hiraeth, gaze reversal</i>

The play opens warmly enough to feel like a memory you could romanticise – and then refuses to let you keep it that way.

The Prologue opens in a kind of 'mythical Poland': not the historical country as such, but a sensory safe-place image made of warmth, rhythm, Chopin, language and bodily memory. The Prologue is not performed by Maksio. It is performed by the adult performer, and framed as Finale. That matters. The Polish title's 6+6 structure also matters here, because it aligns with the English title rather than standing apart from it. England is present too – not as a rival home, but as a second home added onto the Polish one, meeting it in the shared condition of 'almost'. Even at the level of title, the Prologue holds a doubled belonging. This is not simply the Poland in which Maksio once lived. It is Poland as reconstructed

threshold: an image of safety assembled later, from the far side of correction, distance and survival.

This is not Poland as politics or documentary reality. It is Poland as safety texture: something assembled from sound, light, language and bodily memory. The piece knows that this refuge was never stable, and does not pretend otherwise. It offers the image while also showing how and why such images get made – because the mind assembles refuge from sound, light and language when actual safety is unstable.

That matters especially in relation to spring. *Prawie Wiosna* is not simply ‘almost spring’ in a decorative sense, but a threshold state: thaw rather than arrival, loosening rather than full return. The writer’s surname, *Marzec*, quietly intensifies that logic. The month of almost-arrival is already sitting inside the name. Because the Prologue is also Finale, that threshold cuts two ways. It is not only the child-world before punishment. It is also the adult performer’s attempt to return to something that can no longer be inhabited directly, only staged, approached, and almost re-entered.

Then reverence becomes pressure. In the Chopin strand, the phrase ‘national treasure’ behaves like a trap-word: it sounds like love, but it functions like possession. A treasure must be curated, corrected, kept representative, protected from mess. Admiration quietly turns into a contract. What looks like cultural pride can become a demand for legibility, discipline and self-management. In that sense, ‘national treasure’ does not sit opposite to masking. It mirrors it. Praise becomes surveillance; tenderness becomes correction; belonging becomes something you must earn by remaining presentable.

The two-body form makes that contract visible. The speaking performer negotiates belonging while the Black Figure holds the witness position – the part that registers what gets edited out in order to stay acceptable. This matters because the pressure in the piece is not only external. It has already been internalised. The body has learned how to tidy itself before anyone asks. So the split on stage is not just between self and society, but between the self that performs legibility and the self that witnesses the cost of performing it.

This is the territory of *hiraeth* – not nostalgia, which has an object, but the ache for a version of yourself that was corrected before it could finish forming. The

homeland here is not simply a lost place. It is a place that becomes more charged as it becomes less reachable, more coherent as it becomes less inhabitable. What is being longed for is not only where one came from, but the self that might have existed there under kinder conditions. Because the Prologue is already a return, that longing is not innocent. The safe image is already retrospective. It is shaped by the adult body that needs to make it in order for the piece to begin at all. There is also a specifically Polish resonance underneath this. The piece does not need to state the history of partition outright for it to be felt, but the afterlife of 123 years in which Poland disappeared as a state while surviving in language, music, ritual and imagination sits quietly behind this logic. Home is not only remembered here; it is maintained in forms that outlast direct possession.

That is where the Lublin moment acquires its deeper force. Lublin sits inside this mythology not simply as a hometown, but as a place transformed by distance. In the population recital, the number corrects itself from 361,448 to 361,447. That sounds tiny, almost throwaway. But the corrected number is prime. Remove the '1' that is the writer – the one who left – and the city changes mathematical status. It becomes indivisible.

This matters because the shift is not only numerical. It is emotional and mythical. A civic quantity that ought to belong to the world of ranking, comparability and administration briefly becomes resistant to arrangement. The subtraction does not merely reduce the number. It sanctifies it. The place becomes more singular once it is no longer inhabited directly. Distance does not preserve the lived home; it idealises it.

That is why this belongs specifically to mythical Poland. Once removed from daily life, the homeland stops functioning only as place and starts functioning as image, pressure, ache and symbol. In that sense, the Lublin prime is not just a clever number detail. It is a formal enactment of the very logic *hiraeth* names: home becoming more absolute precisely through absence.

The stammered 'L-I-lublin' belongs to the same process. Naming home becomes effortful not because the place is unknown, but because it is overcharged. The mouth hesitates where intimacy and self-consciousness meet. The person is already editing. That hesitancy is not a contradiction of longing; it is one of longing's symptoms.

The piece therefore refuses a tidy morality tale. It does not simply oppose homeland to exile, or pride to shame, or sweetness to violence. It stages the contradiction: the hunger for a safe homeland and the sweetness of being seen, alongside the way those same forces can demand self-erasure in return. The place that nourishes can also correct. The culture that holds tenderness can also produce the red pen.

The ending returns responsibility to the collective gaze. The room is left in its own light. The question is no longer only what was lost, or what home might once have been, but what kinds of looking turn people and places into objects that must remain coherent, beautiful and representative. The play does not restore the homeland. It shows how the homeland gets made: through memory, correction, distance, longing and the pressure of being watched.

Entry Point 4: The Height Arc

Focus: <i>Staging entry. ground/height as physical, numerical and ethical argument</i>
Key devices: <i>desk/podium logic, ranking, ascent/descent, heel-lifts and body cues, medals, cloud/fog inversion, Sisyphus height labour, floor-images, audience as final platform</i>

This piece has a clear vertical spine: a negotiation between ground and height – literal, choreographic, numerical and ethical. Height is never just spectacle here; it accumulates meaning as the piece moves – aspiration first, then exposure, then the weight of being raised at all. Ground is not neutral either: it carries safety, shame, collapse and, crucially, it is the place where what has been dropped remains. The piece keeps returning to the question of what gets raised, what gets lowered, and what it costs a body to move between those states.

The desk and chair function as height machinery – a small podium-world where posture, performance and being ‘correct’ are demanded. The audience sees it, sees it removed, and later sees it return. Across the piece, the body is repeatedly pulled between floor logic and elevated performance logic: ants on the ground, cities arranged by rank, the book carried low or close to the body, then later the

climb towards desk, pedestal and shoulders. Height becomes part of the language of value.

That vertical logic begins immediately in the Prologue. The body is already reaching, lifting and rising: the book is explored at different heights, held in front of the face, above the head and close to the chest; the movement includes flashes of ballet vocabulary; the environment responds as if height and contact are being learned in real time. The upward impulse is there from the start, before the system's rules arrive. It is written into movement and supported by the responsive logic of the room itself. It also matters that this opening state is *Prawie Wiosna* – Almost Spring. Spring carries its own vertical promise: growth, emergence, thaw, the first signs of upward return. But here that arrival is held at the threshold. The piece begins not with spring itself, but with its not-yet. Because the Prologue is also a Finale, even this upwardness is already retrospective: an adult body staging the possibility of return.

Scene 1 continues that logic through image, perception and physical proximity to the ground. Maksio's world begins with looking upwards – sky, clouds, Mama – but much of the scene is spent on the floor or close to it: sitting, folding, dropping down, returning to ground contact. This is part of a wider pattern in the piece: the Maksio scenes are generally staged closer to the ground, with more physical contact, more weight and more touch. Against that groundedness, the inversion lands: fog is a cloud that has descended to ground level. The piece does not treat height as a stable category; what is 'up there' can come down, surround the body and become inhabitable.

Scene 2 extends the same logic through ranking. The city list is not only a recital of populations; it is a vertical ordering of places. Lublin is quietly lifted above where it belongs. In reality, it ranks ninth by population, so in a true top-eight sequence it would be excluded entirely. The scene therefore does not simply misorder the city; it rescues it from omission by raising it. That follows the scene's larger rule: height is not only physical but social and symbolic. To be placed higher is to be granted status, ambition and visibility – even if the placement is wrong, forced or unstable.

The *Wiosna* strand makes that vertical logic more explicit. *Wiosna* appears twice in the scene titles, but never as simple arrival: in the Prologue it is almost spring, and in Scene 3 it becomes spring gone missing. Spring here is not a stable season but a promise of growth that is delayed, misplaced or withheld. If height in the

piece often carries the force of aspiration, emergence and being raised into visibility, *Wiosna* becomes its seasonal version: the expected upward movement that never fully arrives for Maksio. In that sense, the writer's surname *Marzec* sits unusually close to the work's larger grammar – spring encoded in the name, but staged as threshold, loss and search rather than fulfilment.

Scene 4, *Taxonomy*, turns height into official language. The scene classifies clouds by altitude – high, mid and low – translating the wonder of Scene 1 into institutional categorisation. It matters too that cumulus is falsely fixed at 'exactly 8 metres above the ground': a cloud type is pinned to an absurdly precise vertical measurement, and the child's upward imagination is converted into recital under assessment light. Height is no longer exploratory; it is administered.

One way to extend the height argument is to see pressure itself as vertical. The play's storm imagery is not decorative; it belongs to the same upward logic as climbing, ranking and elevation. Scene 1 plants this with deceptive innocence. Maksio, delighted by *urwanie chmury*, suddenly announces that 'zaraz będzie straszne burzysko' – that 'a hell of a storm is coming'. At first this feels like a child's comic over-response to language. In retrospect, it sounds like a structural forecast. *Taxonomy* then formalises the idea by arranging clouds according to height, showing how what is overhead can thicken, gather and turn threatening. The falsely precise cumulus at exactly eight metres is especially charged: low enough to dominate perception, but still outside touch – close, obscuring and unreachable, like fog lifted just beyond contact. For Maksio, that would not feel like neutral weather but torment. From that point on, the sensory violence of the non-prime scenes can be read as the storm finally breaking. Scene 9 arrives like the first strange wave, in the form of the bell anomaly. Scene 10 hits harder, a renewed assault. Scene 11 lets the pressure ease. But Scene 12 proves that it has not gone: it returns at the end like another band of the same hurricane. The effect is less of a single crash than of repeated storm fronts moving through. In that sense, height in the play is also what accumulates above the nervous system before descending into sound, rupture and overwhelm.

The *Wołacz* scene adds another kind of ascent. While declining *chandra*, Maksio counts on his fingers case by case, physically moving upwards through the grammatical sequence until he reaches the final case and cannot complete it. Language climbs towards direct address and then fails at the point of greatest exposure.

Scene 8 makes the height arc bodily and microscopic. *Climbing and Slipping* is not only verbal or numerical ascent; it is written into the musculature. As the Fibonacci sequence rises, the heels begin to lift – first slightly, then more fully – as if the body itself is trying to climb before it is allowed to. These are small vertical events, but they matter: ambition leaks into posture before it succeeds in language.

The accumulating medals belong to the same vertical grammar. Each medal marks a form of ascent through approval: being raised in value, promoted within the system, made visibly worthy. But they are also weight. The higher the symbolic status, the heavier the jacket becomes. Ascent and burden turn out to be part of the same mechanism.

Scene 11 briefly resets the relationship to the ground. Here the performer and the Black Figure meet at the same level, close to the floor, so that their bodies mirror each other. The image reads as a moment of integration: two figures occupying the same ground-plane. Shared grounding becomes the precondition for any later shared ascent.

Sisyphus is the most explicit articulation of height as labour. Up again, up again – and then the trap of what comes after: expectation, legibility, applause, the demand to remain worthy of the height once achieved. The applause swell extends that vertical pressure: escalation without release, altitude without safety. At the end of the Sisyphus monologue, the performer jumps down to the ground. The descent is immediate and decisive. What follows is striking: the body can drop down, but it cannot easily rise again.

This is why the floor-images after and around Sisyphus matter so much. The play repeatedly places the performer back on the ground in the burnout scenes, creating a stark counter-image to aspiration and elevation. In *Bell Anomaly*, the audience is likely to expect the third bell to restore the body to the desk – to make him rise back into the system position – but instead the lights reveal him still on the floor, unmoved since blackout. The reset signal arrives; the ascent does not. For much of Act 2, just as Masking M loses the ability to call out, he also appears to lose the ability to stand up. The body remains close to the ground, unable to lift itself. The desk can hold him upright, but it does not restore that agency. It is only in Scene 13 – *Mantra* – that the body finally rises again, mirrored by the Black

Figure beside him. The system attempted a reset in Scene 9 and failed; the lift comes later, through relation rather than command.

Later, as the final waltz develops, the verticality becomes visible in the form itself. The waltz is rise-and-fall encoded in triple time – the up-down-down of its metre written into the body before any dramatic intention arrives. *La Valse* in particular is a piece that builds until it can no longer support its own altitude. The bodies lower and rise more clearly as the dance progresses, and height becomes rhythmic rather than merely positional.

The vertical logic also runs through the play's first and last spoken lines. Scene 1 begins with 'Mamo, zobacz! Na mniebo' – a child-slip fusing self and sky, so that selfhood is already oriented upwards in the first utterance. That opening plea is also relationally vertical: Maksio looks up to Mama, so the call is directed upwards from below to someone physically and structurally above him. By the final line, that geometry has changed. Lifted on the Black Figure's shoulders, he speaks not from below but from a position where the addressee can be imagined at eye level. The ending does not simply repeat the opening call at a greater height; it changes its terms.

By the final sequence, height becomes fully relational. The desk is climbed, then the body is lifted higher still on the Black Figure's shoulders. This is the most exposed vertical image in the piece, and crucially it is not achieved alone. Height here is shared, supported and precarious. That precariousness is not incidental: standing on another person's shoulders is not a triumphant posture but a high-wire one, where the altitude is real and the stability is borrowed. The piece has already shown what it means to be raised by systems of ranking, approval and pressure. The ending offers a different kind of lift: not elevation as demand, but height made possible by another body's support.

Another ascent runs quietly underneath the piece. The repeated 'Mamo...' calls accumulate quickly across the early Maksio scenes and then plateau for most of the performance, as if the upward reach has been suspended. Only in the final moment does the count move again, bringing the total to twenty-one. The pattern is not foregrounded, but it sits inside the piece as a slow accumulation: an address that rises early, waits, and only completes its arc at the end.

C. Relational and perceptual ethics

Entry Point 5: Autistic Dialogue, Not Explanation

Focus: *Framing entry: recognition over explanation; dialogue as dramaturgy*

Key devices: *recognition structure, bilingual redistribution of access, prologue-as-finale framing, bodily conditioning as shared dialogue, wordless mirroring in Act 2*

This is a one-person piece that behaves like a conversation – not a lesson, not a case study.

Act 1, from Prologue to *Wołacz*, is structured as a kind of autistic dialogue in the wild: a sequence of recognitions presented as ordinary world-logic rather than symptoms, metaphors or evidence for diagnosis. The invitation is quiet. Not ‘understand this’, but ‘do you recognise it?’ The piece does not ask the audience to decode a condition from outside. It asks whether what is being offered lands as familiar, strange, adjacent, or newly legible.

That matters because the work refuses the usual educational contract around neurodivergence on stage. It does not stop to explain itself into acceptability. It does not flatten experience into a neat model of causes and effects. Instead, it stages perception, pressure, patterning, delight, rupture and correction as dramaturgical facts. Meaning emerges through recurrence, relation and form rather than through diagnostic commentary.

The bilingual structure supports that contract. Polish passages carry warmth, first-relation and body-logic; English passages carry school logic, performance and rationalisation. Comprehension is redistributed rather than flattened: different kinds of attention are rewarded at different times. The result is not exclusion for its own sake, but a more truthful model of cross-system experience – what can be carried across, what cannot, and what gets distorted when translation becomes performance.

The dialogue is not only conceptual. It is also physical. Through repetition and conditioning, the piece gradually plants responses in the spectator’s body. It does not rely only on emotional resonance or explanatory empathy. It builds a shared

sensorium of anticipation, interruption and flinch. Do you now also feel the bells in your body? Do you brace before the page rip? In that sense, the work creates a temporary bodily dialogue across neurotypes: not sameness of experience, but a shared live grammar of tension, expectation and response.

That dialogue does not end when the piece leaves the recognitional textures of Act 1. After *Wołacz*, it changes form. The accumulated weather of the first half begins to discharge in sensory-heavy scenes where the audience is no longer being asked only 'do you recognise this?' but also 'can you stay with what this system does in a body?' Act 2 remains dialogic, but less through words than through consequence, mirroring and co-regulation. The main arc of the second half is Masking M's gradual integration with the Black Figure: a dialogue without speech, carried through witness, interruption, parallel grounding, synchrony and support. The audience is not asked to undergo discomfort for its own sake. It is asked to inhabit, with warning and preparation, the shift from patterned recognition to embodied cost.

Staging follows the same principle. The Prologue is labelled as Finale to frame integration as loop rather than destination. Symbols are laid down before meaning; the world responds before it judges. Visible stage-assistant actions make the apparatus legible rather than hidden. The piece keeps placing the audience in relation to structure before it offers them explanatory comfort.

This is how it resists voyeurism. It gives the audience a way to be addressed without demanding disclosure, diagnosis or pity in return. It offers proximity without over-exposure. What emerges is not 'autism explained', but a mode of theatrical relation in which recognition carries more weight than paraphrase.

At its deepest level, this is also a dialogue with people who operate on a similar perceptual wavelength to the one that made it. That does not invalidate other responses, nor does it divide the room into those who 'get it' and those who do not. But it does mean that the texture of the piece will not register identically for everyone. Some spectators may encounter it as a formally rich, moving and unusual theatrical event. Others may also encounter a denser kind of recognition: not only understanding the structure, but feeling that the structure thinks in a way that is intimately familiar. The piece remains open. It simply does not pretend that all access is identical.

The ending completes that dialogue by shifting attention outwards. The room becomes the last image not because the piece has stopped speaking, but because the conversation has changed hands.

Entry Point 6: The Gaze Is the Ending

Focus: <i>Ethics entry: spectatorship, responsibility, refusal of release</i>
Key devices: <i>no curtain call, applause economy, gaze reversal, vocative handover, two-act hinge, post-AI embodiment, Wołacz cards</i>

The final image is not the performer. It is the audience.

The ending move is simple: no curtain call, house lights up, the room left holding its own gaze. This is not a flourish. It is the ethics of the piece made physical. Disability, including invisible disability, is not framed here as a private self-fix. It is negotiated socially, in rooms and institutions and applause economies that write themselves back into the body.

But the ethical contract does not only arrive at the end. Midway through, it changes.

The pivotal hinge is *Wołacz*. Up to that point, the piece behaves like dialogue without certainty of reply: address is made, recognition is offered, and the performer keeps moving even when no one answers. In Scene 6+1, that logic breaks. The vocative is begun and cannot be completed. A call is made – ‘Wołacz...’ – and withheld. The performer looks up towards ‘Mamo’, and she does not respond.

In that gap, the dramaturgy turns. Address stops being private longing and becomes public risk. The performer is suddenly visible in a different way – not as someone presenting material, but as someone exposed by the act of calling, held in the room’s attention and made vulnerable by it. It is the moment the audience stops being witness-to-content and becomes the addressee in the space.

That is why the second half feels as though it happens in the audience’s gaze. Integration becomes something undertaken under live spectatorship, with real

stakes and real reciprocity. The presence of the Black Figure sharpens the ethics: one body performs, while another body holds the position of witness, shadow labour and erasure. The question becomes less 'what is he doing?' and more 'what does this room do with what it sees?'

The red pen's journey also shifts here. If the first half frames the pen as an instrument of self-correction – rule, evaluation, external judgement internalised – then the *Wołacz* hinge allows that instrument to be handed elsewhere. The performer cannot carry correction alone. The corrective apparatus is placed into the room, towards the centre of light – not as a gimmick, but as an admission: correction now exists beyond the body. The pen's absence after this point becomes meaningful. The audience 'has it' – the power and responsibility to correct, to validate, to withhold, to name, to misname. The piece extends that ethics beyond the room through the *Wołacz* cards – 'What I would like to say to ___ is ___' – a participatory aftercare structure that offers a release valve and begins a living archive of unsaid address. Care is built into the design, not added on.

This is also why the final vocative lands differently. When the performer later says, 'Mamo, look at me', it is not a sentimental return to childhood address. It is a handback of responsibility. The second half has shown an attempted integration – a reassembly of self and shadow, a way of staying in the room. The final address says: I have attempted my part; now you do yours.

Applause is staged within the same ethical framework. After *Sisyphus* it begins unevenly around the house, then is overtaken by recorded applause until it reads as pressure rather than praise. The point is not to trick anyone. It is to show how social signals recruit bodies, and how rooms attempt to close what has not actually resolved.

And then the work refuses that closure. No curtain call means no easy exchange in which vulnerability is repaid with clapping and a smile. House lights up means the gaze is returned to the collective. The audience is not offered an exit into performance etiquette. It is left in the final light with its own looking – asked to notice how quickly a room turns complexity into approval, pity, narrative or tidy catharsis.

The piece also makes a post-AI argument without fuss: fluent explanation is cheap now; lived consequence is not. Language that sounds coherent can be generated, but the bodily cost of breath, silence, overload, hesitation, trained obedience and holding yourself together in public cannot. Theatre can still insist on those non-transferable parts. And because this is theatre, that fact does not sit in the performer alone. It is distributed across live spectatorship and the ethical weight of how people look.

Entry Point 7: Look Harder = Notice More

Focus: *Perception ethics entry: learning how to look; repeat viewing as re-reading; autism as complex grammar rather than spectacle*

Key devices: *handout as cipher; 8 + 8 scene loop (Prologue + Epilogue), Wołacz as Act 1 hinge; dense callback network; intentional 'mishap' design; opt-in counting; recognition pleasure / social mismatch; "Just something I noticed" as collective afterlife*

This entry point treats the piece as a lesson in legibility – not in the sense of 'understanding autism properly', but in learning how attention changes what becomes visible. The script is deliberately dense: built from numbers, callbacks and rigorous compliance with an underlying mathematical grammar. It does not ask the audience to catch everything in real time. Instead, it stages a familiar autistic problem in reverse: the world often assumes that if something is not immediately legible, it is not there. This work proposes the opposite – that complexity can be present without being instantly readable, and that 'look harder' can be both invitation and demand.

The handout changes the terms of that demand. The play's design can feel almost hermetic on a first encounter, but the handout functions as a cipher: it does not explain the work from the outside, it teaches the audience how to enter it on its own terms. Rather than translating every layer, it offers a coded literacy – a way of noticing that some spectators will take up eagerly, and others will only skim. That unevenness is not a failure of access. It is a redistribution of it. Different kinds of attention become valid currencies in the room.

Repeat viewing is where this becomes relational rather than merely formal. The script is built as a loop – scored as 8 + 8 scenes, with *Wołacz* functioning as the Act 1 hinge and transfer point of address. Returning to the piece mirrors a post-diagnosis experience: the same facts, the same events, the same memories – and then a different reading of them. Nothing ‘new’ has happened, yet meaning shifts because the frame has shifted. The second viewing becomes a practical demonstration of that re-reading. The audience is no longer trying to follow plot alone, but testing hypotheses, noticing returns and watching earlier moments acquire different weight.

This is also where apparent accidents change status. Elements that might be dismissed on a first viewing as stage mishaps, slips or rough edges can later clarify as designed deviations – not as a trick, but as a reminder that perception is trained. The piece quietly conditions the spectator into a new assumption: not that everything must mean something, but that some meanings only appear once you have learned the grammar they operate in.

For pattern-focused spectators, that learning can be intensely pleasurable. There is a specific kind of joy in realising that a hunch was correct – that the structure holds, that the counting was not pointless, that attention has been rewarded. But the work keeps that pleasure opt-in. Counting is never required in order to be moved by the piece. Many viewers will register the architecture only as a felt coherence – a rhythm, a tightening and loosening of pressure, a form that knows where it is going before they do.

The point is not to divide the audience into those who ‘get it’ and those who do not. The point is to stage a social reality autistic people often inhabit: the moment of excited recognition at something you can see very clearly, alongside the simultaneous knowledge that others may not see it, may not care, or may treat that excitement as excessive.

A possible longer-term afterlife for that logic is the project’s proposed “Just something I noticed” forum: a moderated website space where audiences could place counts, echoes, hunches and partial discoveries alongside what others noticed. The internal Scene Map would remain unpublished; what becomes public instead is the act of mapping. In that form, the piece does not hand over a master-key, but creates the conditions for legibility to accumulate collectively, through distributed attention and shared acts of noticing over time.

In that sense, 'look harder' is not a puzzle-master slogan. It is a proposition about reading. Stay with the pattern. Revisit the thing that first seemed opaque. Allow coherence to emerge late. The piece does not demand total decoding. It offers the experience of discovering that legibility is not fixed, and that what becomes visible depends partly on how one has learned to look – and, sometimes, on what others help one to notice.

D. Theatre machinery / tone / formal misalignment

Entry Point 8: Systems, Conditioning, Applause Economy

Focus: <i>Systems entry: compliance, praise-as-contract, rooms as training environments</i>
Key devices: <i>stage apparatus, correction tool, applause economy, praise-as-ownership, gaze economy</i>

This entry point treats the work as an apparatus. The play's world is minimal but loaded: book, desk, chair, red pen, jacket, medals, bells, footsteps, stage assistants, applause, blackout, house lights. None of these function as neutral props or transitions. They are the visible components of a system that trains the body, reads it, rewards it, corrects it and finally exposes the audience's place within that process.

The desk and chair are not simply furniture. They are part of an institutional arrangement: a posture-world in which legibility, correctness and performance are produced. The red pen is even more exact. It is not just a school object or a symbol of criticism. It is a correction tool that gradually becomes a dramaturgical principle: revision externalised, then internalised, then redistributed across the room. The system is therefore not only built out of objects but carried through the hand: held, gripped, used, released. When the furniture is removed but the correction tool remains, its priorities are made brutally clear.

This is where conditioning broadens into apparatus. The piece is not only asking how a body learns to obey a cue. It is asking what kinds of room make that obedience necessary, intelligible, and even praiseworthy. Achievement,

performance and social survival become entangled. The medals are real. The effort is real. The competence is real. But what the world reads in that competence is not the labour required to produce it. It reads proof of ease. Compliance is repeatedly mistaken for flourishing.

Applause is central to this economy. The play stages it not as uncomplicated reward but as a mechanism: praise as pressure, approval as contract, public affirmation as something that can trap as much as it confirms. The Sisyphus monologue makes that mechanism bodily. Its language keeps returning to the hand: hands on stone, hands like stones, hands asked to hold what no human hands could hold. When applause arrives immediately afterwards, the contradiction sharpens: we applaud with our hands, using them to reward the very labour the speech has just revealed as impossible. At that point, applause stops functioning as response and starts functioning as enforcement. The room does not merely witness the performer; it participates in the social machinery through which the performer is received, measured and kept in role. Applause is not outside the system. It is one of its cleanest forms.

The same logic extends into the project's "national treasure" pressure. Praise becomes a form of ownership. Admiration becomes a demand to remain legible in the shape that has been rewarded. The problem is not that success is false. It is that success is too easily used as evidence that the structure producing it is benign. The piece keeps returning to this paradox: the performance is genuine, the achievement is genuine, and yet the reading of both can still be profoundly wrong.

This is why the ending matters so much here. No curtain call, house lights up, 72 seconds of silence: the apparatus does not resolve into the familiar theatre ritual of release. Instead, the room is left visible to itself. The audience is not asked simply what it thought or felt. It is made to notice that it has been part of an economy of looking, rewarding, correcting, waiting and expecting. In that sense, the apparatus does not end at the stage. It extends into spectatorship itself.

Entry Point 9: Laughing Under the Mechanism

Focus: *Tone entry. humour as connection, camouflage and system tool*

Key devices: *two humour registers (Maksio/Masking M), applause-as-joke, refusal of catharsis*

Humour in this piece is not relief. It is navigation.

The laughter is split across two dramaturgical worlds: the unmasked child, Maksio, and the masked adult, Masking M. Early humour invites the audience close with bodily, sensory and bilingual mischief. It has the energy of delighted pattern-discovery, theatrical overstatement, and the pleasure of a thought being too alive to keep private. Later humour hardens into something drier, tighter and more recursive: wit under pressure, timing as management, fluency with strain still audible underneath.

That tonal shift is not a mood swing. It maps how visibility is negotiated. Sometimes humour is a hand offered out. Sometimes it is camouflage. Sometimes it is a barrier that lets a person stay present in the room while revealing as little as possible. The same instinct that makes Maksio a natural performer becomes, under different conditions, a survival tool.

That is why the humour in the piece keeps changing its weight. Moments that land first as funny can later return carrying a deeper sadness or a sharper pressure. On revisit, the audience may find that what seemed merely playful was already structurally painful, or that a joke was doing more defensive labour than it first appeared. The play does not set comedy against tragedy. It lets laughter and pain occupy the same mechanism, so that humour becomes one of the forms through which tragedy is lived rather than escaped.

The applause sequence after Sisyphus becomes the cruellest joke in the piece: clapping that begins as approval and turns into capture. The joke is not 'got you!'. It is the dreadful recognisability of the mechanism: the way social reward can become demand, the way a room can keep performing affirmation even as it tightens the trap.

Because humour is a social technology, it becomes political here. The play shows how rooms reward the version of you that is funny, fluent and manageable – and what happens when that version runs out. Laughter can create closeness, but it can also police legibility. It can make a person beloved and misread at the same time.

The ending refuses the standard theatre exchange in which applause cleans everything up. Instead, the final move returns the mechanism to the audience: house lights up, no curtain call, the room left with its own laughter and its own habits of response still hanging in the air. Humour has not dissolved the pressure. It has shown one of the ways the pressure is survived.

Entry Point 10: Almost Right, Then Wrong

Focus: *Formal entry – near-patterns, misalignment, structure as embodied affect*

Key devices: *near-patterns, off-by-one logic, Pi/Fibonacci feel, EMOTIONS glitch, Black Figure as witness*

The tension in this piece comes from watching something that should be right go subtly wrong. It is built from near-patterns: rhythms that almost resolve, sequences that almost behave, rituals that almost soothe. Often the wrongness is small – one digit, one step, one position. That is why it registers in the body before it can be fully explained. One recurring mechanism of this misalignment is being off by one. Sometimes a number is one too high. Sometimes it is one too low. Sometimes a sequence stops one step short. Sometimes a position is shifted by one place. The forms vary, but the effect is similar: the original pattern remains visible underneath the error. The audience is made to feel both the structure and its slight displacement at the same time.

That is what makes *almost right* more disturbing than obvious wrongness. Chaos releases you from expectation; near-correctness does not. The pattern is still there, still promising resolution, still close enough to recognition that the body keeps leaning towards it. Friction, anticipation, dread and withheld relief all travel through that gap. The nervous system does not experience the structure as absent. It experiences it as nearly settling and then failing to do so.

This becomes one of the piece's clearest formal languages for masking. The self is not replaced; it is slightly displaced into legibility. Moved just far enough to pass, but not far enough for the original shape to disappear. The adjustment is small,

but it must be maintained continuously, and its cost accumulates across the piece.

The most intimate example is the *chandra* scene. In Scene 6+1=8-1, Maksio counts the letters of *chandra* on his fingers and arrives at six. He whispers *sześć*. But *chandra* has seven letters – and in some case forms, effectively reaches eight. He is off by one at the moment of trying to name his own low mood. The miscount is not just numerical. It is structural. He moves through the grammatical cases and reaches *Wołacz* – the calling case – and cannot complete it. The missing step is not merely the next unit in a sequence. It is the step that would turn naming into address. The call cannot quite happen. The mechanism fails at the point where someone else would have to be there.

The autobiographical example arrives in Scene 2. Lublin is in fact only Poland's ninth biggest city, yet in the recital it appears seventh and is then announced as eighth. The distortion works at two levels at once: the city is first pulled upwards in the ranking, then numbered one place below the position it occupies in the sequence. It is elevated, but incorrectly. Then the population figure corrects itself: three hundred and sixty-one thousand, four hundred and forty-eight... forty-seven. The change is tiny, but its effect is disproportionate. Not only is 47 prime. The full corrected number – 361,447 – is prime too. In other words, the subtraction does not merely alter the figure; it changes its mathematical status altogether.

That matters because the scene is built from ranking, ordering and comparability. Population tables belong to the world of countable units, sortable places, civic legibility. But the slip briefly turns Lublin into something indivisible. A city being ranked becomes, for a moment, mathematically resistant to arrangement. Within the logic of the piece, that reads less as error than as sanctification. The correction sounds like loss – one person gone, one digit reduced – but it produces irreducibility. The city becomes singular precisely through subtraction. The moment he leaves Lublin, Lublin changes status.

That is also why the moment leans towards *hiraeth*. What is sanctified here is not possession but separation. The place becomes more charged at the moment it can no longer be inhabited directly. The wrongness is tiny; the emotional consequence is not.

From there the same logic becomes more public and more visibly formal. In the Pi recitation, 7s are replaced with 8s. In a number defined by non-repetition, the same displacement occurs twice. The substitutions do not need to be consciously tracked to be felt. Pi matters here not because the audience must decode it, but because it produces the sensation that a structure has been interfered with. The pattern-brain registers the disturbance even when the conscious mind does not.

The Fibonacci ascent works similarly. The climb reaches 88 and breaks one step before 89. That matters because 89 is prime: indivisible, structurally singular, beyond the loop. The sequence does not collapse randomly. It stops one step before that condition could be reached. It terminates at 88 – double 8, double loop, the full piano – and never arrives at the prime beyond it. So the failure is not simply failure. It is a particular form of withholding. Aspiration is staged, but not completed. The body may rise, but the structure prevents escape.

This is why Masking M matters so much as a name. It is not just a label for a persona. It performs the same logic it describes. Seven letters become eight. The name is already a thesis statement: the self displaced into the loop of social legibility. Not replaced, not hidden, not transformed into something wholly other – just moved one position over into performance. That is what gives the name its force. It encodes masking not as costume but as slight structural misalignment.

Seen from that angle, *EMOTIONS* is not an unrelated example but the clearest behavioural version of the same pattern. The scene consists of dictionary-clean definitions delivered under pressure, repeatedly infiltrated by intrusive rules: feelings are for weak people, big feelings are evil, feeling nothing is safety. The syntax remains almost correct. The voice remains controlled. The system still passes as fluent. But the definitions are no longer aligned with themselves. The scene does not show language collapsing; it shows language remaining formally almost intact while its internal co-ordinates have shifted. That is exactly the same logic as elsewhere in the piece: near-correctness maintained at the cost of truth.

So the numerical logic functions here less as puzzle than as affect. Counted structures climb, slip, invert and stall. Pi and Fibonacci matter not because the audience must solve them, but because they produce the feeling of almost-correctness. The body feels the pattern stop behaving: a small jolt, a held breath, a friction where release should have been. The near-miss is not decorative cleverness. It is an emotional event.

Near the end of the piece, this becomes bodily in another way. In Scene 11, two bodies lie parallel on the floor, each reading as the number 1 from above. Together they make 11. What had seemed like a gap or missing middle is revealed not as emptiness but as doubled presence: two irreducible units lying side by side, the witnessing body and the performing body. For a brief time they generate harmony. The abstraction returns to flesh.

That is the piece's formal argument. Masking is not represented here primarily through confession or explanation, but through sustained misalignment: structures that remain almost correct while something essential has been shifted off its true position. The Black Figure holds the witness position while the performing self maintains the adjustment, making that split legible in space as well as language.

The play ends without resolving that tension. The room is lit. The audience inherits the misalignment it has been sitting inside. The red pen is still on the floor.

5. ARTISTIC STATEMENT

A. Origin myth and personal stakes

A lot of this play came from something I 'always knew' – a small, ordinary memory that was never dramatic enough to count as a story. Then I looked at it through autistic masking, and it changed shape completely: the same facts, but a different engine underneath them. That shift was not invention; it was re-reading. And it landed with two simultaneous truths: terror at what had been happening in plain sight, and joy at finally recognising the logic.

The title names the mechanism bluntly: I wrote a book at six, and I proofread it at eight. Six is origin – creation before correction, before the internal editor, before the reflex to pre-empt judgement. Eight is correctness arriving: the red pen, self-surveillance, and the gradual conversion of being right into a survival strategy. The play is not nostalgia for childhood; it is about how a child-world gets reorganised once self-monitoring starts to feel like virtue.

But the book was not the only form that existed at six. Performance was native before it became strategy. As a child, I did not only write things in private – I also kept making theatre. I improvised plays with my brother, often with no explanation beyond 'just act', and later I wrote and 'produced' school plays throughout school, pulling together classmates – including people who had never performed before – simply because I had an idea and wanted to make it happen. No one asked for these pieces. They were not curriculum tasks or sanctioned projects. They existed because making them was fun, because gathering people into a room and rehearsing felt natural, and because the school enjoyed seeing them. That matters to this play's origin. The theatrical instinct was there from the start: idea, execution, rehearsal, shared event. Theatre was not chosen later as a clever frame for the material. It was already living inside the material.

That is also why rehearsal rooms still matter so much to me. Looking back now, what I loved in them was not only performance in the public sense, but the particular atmosphere of rehearsal itself: repetition, timing, adjustment, shared concentration, the sensory and social mesmerism of making something together. They often felt like sensory havens too – low-lit, enclosed, quieter than the outside

world, with a safety in their hush and partial isolation. Seen retrospectively, that too feels like an autistic childhood pleasure that never stopped being true, even when other systems later tried to recruit it into legibility and control.

That is why the Prologue is labelled as a Finale. It begins in 'mythical Poland' – not a country, but a constructed sensory homeland: warm light, rhythm, Chopin, the idea of safety as something you can summon by texture. It never existed as a stable refuge, and the play does not pretend it did. It is a safety image the piece knowingly uses: a place where the world still responds, before the system's signals take over.

Lublin sits inside that mythology too, but not as a political statement about Poland. It became a shame-container: one place where 'everything shameful' could be stored until it stopped being geography and became a myth. That is why the stammer matters – 'L-l-lublin' – because it shows how naming home can turn effortful and self-conscious even when nobody is attacking you: the mouth hesitates because the person is already editing.

Language is where this becomes most obvious. I moved to the UK at eighteen and blended in quickly – to the point that people often did not assume I was foreign. That reads like fluency; it was also a skill with a cost. I had already decided at fourteen to become native-like: I read in English, watched in English, thought in English, translated everything into English. By seventeen, I was winning competitions, including the National English Olympiad, scoring 10/10 on the speaking exam – proof not only of talent, but of how far performative control can go when it becomes a regime of self-monitoring.

That bilingual work has a professional dimension, not just a biographical one. Working as a public service interpreter across English, Polish and Mandarin – with a specialism in mental health – means interpretation is a daily, high-stakes micro-negotiation of what can and cannot cross linguistic and cultural borders. That expertise is not biographical decoration in this piece; it is part of the structural engine of the bilingual dramaturgy. The show's treatment of untranslatability comes from practice.

There is another system of self-editing that runs alongside the linguistic one and compounds with it. Being queer inside a culture that produces both immense tenderness and intense correction – that gives you Chopin and gives you the red

pen – is not a separate strand from the autistic or the linguistic. It is the same mechanism, operating at a different frequency. The piece does not sloganise this. It stages what happens when national pride shades into representational coercion; when a queer Polish body onstage is not just confessing but analysing the machinery that made it readable, unreadable, and marketable by turns. Queer selfhood is present without being centred; it compounds with neurodivergent interiority and linguistic displacement rather than sitting alongside them as a separate topic.

This is why the piece speaks in more than words: because words were one of the first masks. And because performance was native before it became strategy.

B. The play's grammar

This piece does not communicate through text alone. It has a grammar of rhythm, symbol, bilingual shift, repetition and pressure that carries meaning alongside speech. That grammar is not decorative. It is part of how the work thinks, and part of how the audience is asked to read it.

Part 1 (Prologue to *Wołacz*) is written as an autistic dialogue in the wild: a sequence of 'Do you also...?' recognitions that accumulate without being labelled as symptoms, lessons or metaphors. The logic is presented as ordinary world-logic – perceptual, linguistic, social – and the invitation is quiet: not 'understand this', but 'do you recognise it?'.

That shifting begins immediately. Before the audience has context, symbols are laid down without interpretation: the book is centred, closer to the audience, while the desk and chair sit stage right, neutral for now, belonging to another world that has not fully arrived. Stage assistants can remove the desk and chair in full view. If the red pen ends up on the floor and is not picked up, it becomes a thesis: the system can be cleared away; self-correction cannot.

Sound in the Prologue follows the same rule. The only melodic material is breath engineered into pitch: four Chopin waltzes as right-hand-only fragments, twelve notes each, repeating like a key turning. There is no left hand and no chords: primal beauty, melody without guidance, structure withheld on purpose. Underneath is a deep oom-pa-pa pulse – grounding without 'proper

accompaniment'. During these fragments, the environment responds: the room behaves as if it co-regulates rather than evaluates.

Light and movement complete the proposition. The performer is held in a warm tracking 'bubble' – not heroic, not interrogative, more like a moving blanket. The body is adult, but the movement logic is child: jumpy, absorbed, occasionally brushing ballet as reclaimed permission rather than virtuosity. The Prologue therefore functions as an overture of method. The play communicates through embodied logic, sequence and arrangement alongside spoken language – often at the moment language is already strained.

That is not simply a stylistic choice. It is part of the work's grammar. The play treats pattern, rhythm, spatial arrangement and sensory weighting not as atmosphere wrapped around content, but as meaning-bearing structures in their own right. In that sense, its grammar is autistic cognition made theatrical: not because it tries to represent a diagnostic category, but because it organises the stage according to the kinds of sequence, pressure, recurrence and misalignment through which this mind makes sense of things.

Polish and English are not a translation gimmick. They mark two dramaturgical worlds: home/body logic versus system/performance logic, and the play moves between them the way a person does. Numbers are not hidden; they operate as a declared grammar running through titles and structures, present enough to be felt without turning the stage into a maths lecture.

Crucially, that grammar is not decorative. The work reframes pattern-seeking and counting – often dismissed as 'meaningless' or 'obsessive' – as dramaturgical language. Here, attention to detail is architecture and counting is emotional structure. The piece teaches a specific kind of literacy: if you learn to read the patterns, you understand something about how the performer survives, and why the same cognition is so often misread as deficit.

In the same way, the bilingual form is an artistic engine. The Polish scenes are a love letter to what one language can hold that another language can only point towards. This untranslatability is not an obstacle to be removed; it is part of the dramaturgy – a model for what it means to live between systems. The piece makes this felt through mouth-feel, diminutives, case, correction residue and

small internal logics that refuse clean conversion into English. In that sense, Polish is not 'content later translated': it is the work's home-logic medium.

That linguistic gap mirrors a deeper gap: the untranslatability between nervous systems. You cannot step outside your own sensory weighting to compare it with someone else's. You can only infer, approximate and negotiate shared signals. The work does not claim to 'explain autism'. Instead, it stages the limits of cross-system understanding, and the labour involved in making oneself readable.

Masking is treated as near-translation: a practice that produces legibility across systems, but at a cost – energy, time, self-trust and the erosion of joy mid-flow. The red pen and the repeated pressure of 'rightness' become not only a language motif, but an ethical question: what do we lose when we are asked to translate ourselves constantly?

Rather than gatekeeping, the work redistributes access: not everyone receives every layer at the same time, and that is part of the experience. Audiences are invited to track meaning through rhythm, pattern, sound, image and pressure as well as through text. Translations are routes in, not replacements, so that untranslatability can be held as both celebration and truth.

Repeat viewing is part of that redistribution. The script's grammar is not only spatial – objects, languages, numbers – but also temporal. Structured as an 8 + 8 loop, with *Wolacz* operating as the Act 1 hinge, the piece is designed to become legible in layers: on first viewing, patterns can be felt as pressure, rhythm and coherence; on return, they resolve more clearly as architecture, and earlier scenes re-code themselves in light of what follows. The audience is not asked to 'solve' the work, only to notice that noticing is a practice, and that meaning changes when you come back.

Bells and footsteps begin as reliable ritual signals and later malfunction, staging conditioning rather than symbolism. Cries arrive when language hits its cost ceiling. *La Valse* sits inside this as a pressure system: waltz elegance tipping into instability, momentum that feels beautiful right up until it stops being controllable.

The piece is built so the audience does not just hear about masking – it experiences the mechanics of it.

C. Ethics, access, and why now

This piece stages disability and legibility as public negotiation. It does not treat access as the flattening of all difference into one uniform route through the work. Instead, it asks what an audience contract looks like when people receive different layers at different times, and when that unevenness is not a flaw to be apologised for but part of the social truth the piece is staging.

In that sense, access here is redistributed rather than flattened. Early on, the bilingual structure creates a real asymmetry: Polish-speaking spectators may catch extra semantic nuance, while others follow the emotional and physical logic – rhythm, timing, gesture, tone. As the play progresses, comprehension shifts again: humour and meaning become more structural, driven by recursion, misalignment and tiny glitches in repetition. This is not ‘some people are clever’. It is that different kinds of attention get rewarded at different times, and the audience’s usual habits of interpretation are gently – and sometimes brutally – retrained. The point is not to equalise every experience. It is to make space for layered reception without pretending that all forms of access are identical.

Halfway through, that ethics becomes explicit. In *Wołacz*, the call is withheld and then returned from the auditorium, turning the audience into the addressee – ‘Mamo’ – and placing the integration work of the second half inside the room’s gaze. In that hinge, the red pen’s logic also shifts: correction is no longer only a private tool of self-surveillance, but a shared instrument the room is asked to hold. The audience is no longer simply receiving the material. It has been placed into relation with it.

That matters because the politics of the piece live in how it handles looking. The play refuses tidy catharsis and refuses the conventional curtain-call release that lets everyone leave feeling clean. House lights come up; the audience becomes the final image. That is a worldview demand written into form: disability – including invisible disability – is not privately solvable by the individual alone. It is negotiated socially and institutionally, and the room is part of the apparatus that trains, rewards, corrects, overlooks, or refuses to notice.

The conditioning devices are staged openly, not hidden as ‘atmosphere’. Bells and footsteps operate as behavioural signals: they begin as clean ritual and later glitch, while the body’s obedience persists even when the signal is clearly

malfunctioning. Applause is treated in the same spirit: after Sisyphus, clapping can begin scattered from different corners of the house and then be overtaken by recorded applause until it becomes a pressure system. The point is not to trick the audience, but to make visible how rooms produce and reinforce legibility.

If a small 'seed' group is used to sharpen the scattered-corners effect, it is framed explicitly as a consensual mirror of conditioning rather than a trick. Pre-briefed audience members are never presented as organic spontaneity, and they are also instructed not to clap at the end. The ethics of the piece depend on not reproducing manipulation while analysing it.

The 'why now' has a specific political edge. The post-Brexit reality for Eastern European migrants in the UK – in which linguistic self-editing and cultural legibility remain under ongoing pressure, not as historical memory but as daily condition – gives this work a concrete contemporary context that goes beyond any single identity. This is that landscape, held without making it the only subject. The piece sits inside a public culture that still demands managed coherence: fluent enough, grateful enough, legible enough, untroubling enough.

The piece extends its ethics beyond the room. The Wołacz cards – 'What I would like to say to ___ is ___' – offer an optional release valve after the performance and begin a living community archive of what audiences needed to say but could not say elsewhere. They do not resolve the negotiation the show has staged. They acknowledge that it continues.

In longer-term development, that archive may also take a digital form. The project's full Scene Map exists as an internal collaborator document and will not be published; instead, audiences may be invited to collectively generate their own equivalent of a Scene Map through a moderated "Just something I noticed" space on the project website. There, spectators could place patterns, counts, echoes, structural hunches and partial discoveries alongside what others noticed, allowing meaning to accumulate through distributed attention over time. This is not conceived as marketing or explanatory add-on, but as a structural extension of the piece's dramaturgy. The work argues that pattern-seeking, counting and the discovery of hidden equivalence are forms of intelligence, joy and relation; the forum would enact that claim as a community practice, without requiring any one spectator to hold the whole architecture alone.

Recognition in this piece is not a request for sympathy. It is a collective practice of noticing, relation and partial understanding.

D. Meaning after fluency – post-AI theatre

This piece is being made in a moment when fluent language has become cheap. Systems can now generate persuasive paragraphs about masking, trauma, autism, burnout and care. They can sound coherent, emotionally literate and certain. That changes the artistic question. The point is no longer whether a work can describe an experience convincingly, but whether it can carry the parts that are not reducible to convincing description. Meaning now has to live where fluency cannot go.

This play places meaning in those non-transferable parts. Breath, overload, silence, flinch, rhythm, delay, trained obedience, bodily hesitation, and the effort of holding yourself together in public are not illustrations of the text – they are the text. The piece communicates through parallel systems: numbers, bells, rips, posture, bilingual fracture, repetition, omission, miscount and sonic dysfluency. These are not decorative motifs or hidden cleverness. They are part of the play's grammar.

That matters in a post-AI culture because generated language can imitate fluency, but it does not undergo the stakes that give this work its shape. A model can produce formal glitch, but it does not feel the pressure of a pattern almost resolving. It can describe a hidden structure, but it does not know what it is to discover one and be altered by that discovery. It can generate confident prose, but it does not know the bodily cost of sounding certain when you are full of doubt, intrusive thoughts, or self-surveillance. It does not know what it is to realise you have made a mistake and still keep the surface intact because letting the mistake show feels socially dangerous.

The distinction here is not that humans predict and AI does not. Both can predict, repeat and complete. The difference is that human expectation has consequence. We feel relief when a pattern lands, dread when it slips, shame when we misjudge, pleasure when a hidden connection clicks into place, and grief when language stops carrying what we need it to carry. This piece is built out of those consequential moments: near-patterns, almost-correctness, repeated words thinning into sound, bilingual meanings that refuse full transfer, and

structures that register in the body before they can be explained. When 88 arrives in the Fibonacci sequence and something catches – not in the mind first, but in the ear – that is not an observation to log. It is the structure entering through a different door.

The play also resists a wider cultural tendency that AI intensifies: smoothing, correcting, regularising, packaging. In this work, roughness is often where the truth sits. A stammer, a typo-like public glitch, a miscount, a repeated call, or a word losing semantic meaning and becoming rhythm or mouth-feel may carry more reality than a polished summary. So does the pressure to be right. The piece keeps asking what gets erased when correctness becomes virtue and compliance gets mistaken for functioning.

This is why the work does not make a nostalgic claim for ‘human authenticity’. The argument is not that human-made things carry a special warmth, or that lived experience is self-evidently more valuable than generated coherence. The claim is narrower and harder to dismiss. The piece comes from a particular nervous system, a bilingual history, a pattern-based way of perceiving, and a body trained by correction. Not ‘the human’ as a category – this one. Its structures are not ornamental overlays on content; they are the way this mind makes sense of things. Numbers in this play are not tokens. Words are not always semantic units. They can be sounds, counts, textures, echoes, or bridges between meanings.

The post-AI argument of the piece is therefore not that theatre is live and generated text is not. It is that theatre can still hold forms of meaning that require irreversible time, shared consequence and a body that cannot skip ahead. In a culture where fluent explanation has become the cheapest available currency, this work stakes meaning on what fluency cannot carry: the 72 seconds of silence that cannot be fast-forwarded, the body that does not rise when the bell rings, the pattern that almost resolves and does not. These are not effects. They are consequences – and consequence is what gives the piece its form.

What the audience meets, then, is not simply a set of ideas expressed persuasively. It is a structure that has to be lived through in time. By the end, the question is no longer only what has been understood, but what has been endured, noticed, missed, or prematurely smoothed over.

6. STRUCTURAL COSMOLOGY

Numerology operates as a second score: a counted architecture that shapes rhythm, repetition and absence. It is designed to be felt even when it is not consciously tracked. The piece does not use numbers as decorative cleverness. It uses them as dramaturgical pressure – a way of organising how structure holds, slips, loops, withholds and returns.

A. The 6–7–8 cosmology

The play runs on an arc $6 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 8$, mapping onto creation (6), erasure (7), and looping performance (8).

Maksio (6 letters) and *Sisyphus* (8 letters) sit as the two poles: the unfiltered child self and the adult labour of repetition, exposure and managed endurance. But this is not a neat progression. Six keeps trying to stay embodied; eight keeps pulling the body into spectacle, correction and recursion. Seven is the unstable middle: not a clean bridge between them, but the missing or damaged step that determines the shape of everything around it.

Even if an audience never counts, they can feel the shift. The language-world tightens, thins, and then loops.

B. Prime, divisible, and the logic of almost

The cosmology is governed not only by recurring numbers, but by recurring near-rules. Patterns hold almost completely, then slip. That “almost” is structural, not just thematic. It is also visual: the scene-list notation does not remain perfectly stable, because the piece allows correction, contamination and doubt to enter the counting system itself. In that sense, the prime marks do not simply label the structure from outside; they begin to participate in its aesthetic of almost.

Prime numbers matter because they mark singularity, irreducibility, or points of structural consequence. They resist smooth division. Divisible numbers, by contrast, often belong to systems: arrangement, comparison, repetition, administration, performance. But the piece resists pure opposition. Six itself is divisible, yet it belongs to origin, child-world and making. The number-world is

therefore not moral but unstable: mixed states, partial rules, contaminated categories.

This is one reason Scene 2 matters so much. It is the administrative scene by definition: cities ranked, populations recited, quantities rendered orderly and comparable. Its arithmetic has been engineered around divisibility – by 8 locally, and by 512 globally – so that the scene belongs unmistakably to the world of system, countability and arrangement. But the slip produces 47, and with it a sudden prime intrusion inside that administrative field.

More than that, the scene carries a threefold ripple: the spoken number shifts from 48 to 47; Lublin's population shifts from 361,448 to 361,447; and the full city-total shifts from a number divisible by 512 (8^3) to a prime. At all three levels, the trigger is the smallest possible change: 1. That is the deeper point of the arithmetic. A single unit does not merely reduce the quantity; it alters mathematical status altogether. The scene therefore stages a conflict between divisibility and indivisibility across three linked scales at once: utterance, city, and system. That same tension is echoed in the scene-list notation: Scene 2 is genuinely prime, but its primehood is acknowledged only through the red corrective layer. Mathematical truth remains intact, but it arrives through the wrong system.

72 belongs to this same logic at another scale. In the Epilogue, the 72 seconds of silence are not arbitrary. 72 is one of the piece's most composite numbers: highly divisible, stretchable, open to factorisation. In that sense, it functions almost as the ultimate system-number of the play – endurance under pressure, duration broken into many possible units, a silence that can be inhabited but not reduced. This matters partly because the primes do the opposite. Where prime numbers resist division, 72 invites it. The piece therefore works not only through counted recurrence, but through the tension between what divides cleanly and what does not.

One important example of the "almost-rule" appears in scene numbering. All odd-numbered scenes, except 9, are prime. Scene 9 is therefore an anomaly in multiple senses: it sits where the pattern should hold, but does not. That matters because Scene 9 is also where the system fails to reset the body, where the score begins to misfire more openly, and where the logic of almost becomes visible not as concept but as rupture. The prime-marked scenes tend to behave as points of singular contact or relative irreducibility – but not as a total law. The piece prefers

tendencies with meaningful exceptions to systems that close too neatly. That preference is now carried into the notation itself. Scene 1 retains a black prime mark even though 1 is not prime, but the red pen partially contests it rather than erasing it cleanly; Scene 1•1 is accompanied by a red question mark, making uncertainty itself part of the visual grammar. The result is that even the counting layer is not purely declarative. It is subject to correction, pressure and hesitation – which is precisely the piece’s larger aesthetic of almost.

C. Ghost 7 – the missing middle

Seven is structurally present but not comfortably speakable. The play’s middle year, middle category and middle address are experienced as absence. Erasure is not only thematic; it is counted. Seven behaves like a hole in the sequence that still determines the shape of everything around it.

But seven does not only mark damage. In the piece it also begins to gather the possibility of healing, harmony and re-formed relation. The missing middle never becomes fully stable, but it is not empty. The work repeatedly circles near-sevens and broken completions until, later on, what first appeared only as wound begins to return in more reparative forms.

D. Prologue as an overture of numbers

Before plot assigns meaning, the number-world is already being laid down.

The book-triad announces this immediately: book (4), księga (6), książka (7) – one object, three word-bodies, three number-states. The object is stable; its linguistic bodies are not.

Names arrive as arithmetic as much as biography. Max (4) and Maks (4) are especially important here: the same sound moving between English and Polish, carrying different social and autobiographical pressure. In the UK, Max is the name that passes most easily; Maks is a small but deliberate restoration, a return of Polish spelling inside English-speaking space. The difference is only one letter on the page, but it changes the cultural alignment of the name completely. That is exactly the kind of tiny structural displacement this piece is built from. Maksio

(6) carries the child-self in fuller form; Maks (4) carries abbreviation, expectation and public legibility. The same sound does not guarantee the same identity.

Symmetry appears in titles too: Maksio Marzec (6+6) and Prawie Wiosna (6+6), aligning identity and atmosphere through balanced count.

The Chopin strand carries its own number-pressure. Żelazowa Wola (8+4) places pressure disguised as trivia inside the origin code, while Czerwony długopis (8+8) mirrors national treasure (8+8): correction and celebration as twin mechanisms. At the midpoint, that corrective instrument effectively leaves the performer's hand, only to reappear later in the overture-logic of the ending. The point is not that every title must be decoded. It is that the number-world is already active before narrative catches up.

E. Three and 3+1 as design habit

Alongside the larger 6–7–8 cosmology, the piece repeatedly returns to a smaller structural habit: 3 and 3+1.

Three is one of the play's foundational rhythm-numbers. It belongs to bells, waltz-time, warning structure, ritual repetition and tutorial logic. The handout opens in three title lines; its counting primer unfolds in three lines; the bell-system is built around three strikes; and the waltz itself teaches the audience to feel recurrence in threes before they consciously track any larger mathematical argument. In that sense, three often functions as the piece's first threshold of pattern-recognition: the count at which repetition becomes felt as form.

But the design rarely leaves a triad undisturbed. Again and again, a fourth element arrives – not always to complete the pattern, but often to tilt, expose or trouble it. This 3+1 habit appears across multiple layers of the piece. There are three essays and one bio in the programme; three Maksio scenes saturated with "Mamo" before the wołacz-free interruption; three major Black Figure mirror-scenes (9, 11, 13) and one anomaly where the figure enters outside the mirror logic (10); three clean 12-note breath-waltz fragments in the Prologue and a final one shortened to 11; three scenes in Act 1 where footsteps culminate in a rip and one where the pattern breaks; three attempts at integration before the fuller state of Scene 14. The form repeatedly establishes a triad, then adds a fourth term that completes, shadows, breaks or re-reads what came before.

This also has a musical echo in Chopin, especially in many nocturne phrases: a recurring habit of three closely related gestures or small variations, followed by a fourth phrase that resolves, redirects or subtly re-reads the pattern. The piece does not quote that structure mechanically, but it shares its pressure-logic: repetition becoming expectation, and the fourth term arriving not as simple continuation but as turn.

This is one reason the piece's repetitions rarely feel mechanical. They do not simply accumulate; they often arrive as three-plus-deviation. The fourth term is where pattern becomes dramaturgy: where repetition reveals its pressure, and where the audience begins to feel that structure is not merely recurring but changing its meaning as it returns.

F. Hiraeth – the mathematics of almost

Hiraeth is a Welsh word for the longing for a home that never existed – or could have existed, if the interruption had been kinder. It is not nostalgia, which has an object. It is the ache for a version of yourself that was corrected before it could finish forming.

The play lives in the space between 6 and 8. What happens to an autistic person in that gap – between the unfiltered child-self and the adult labour of correction and performance – is not a developmental stage. It is an absence. A missing middle. A gap that determines the shape of everything around it. *Hiraeth* is the name for that gap. It is seven letters, for a reason.

Welsh and Polish recognise each other across this: both languages survived empires that tried to correct them into something easier to govern; both carry identity in encrypted form; both had populations who learned to carry two selves. Autistic masking works at the same scale, in the same grammar. The show holds all three simultaneously – not as symbolic correspondence, but as lived structural similarity.

This is also why the piece refuses the comforting version of any of those identities. It is intensely, painfully, beautifully Polish – and it knows that Polishness, like Welshness, like queerness, like autistic cognition, has been subject to correction, curation and representational coercion. *Hiraeth* is not sentimental. It is the precise technical term for what the 7 costs.

G. Wołacz as symmetry axis

Wołacz is the hinge where address breaks and is returned from the room. It is also the natural symmetry axis of the piece, because the vocative is the only grammatical case that directly assumes a second presence: it does not simply name, classify or place, but calls across a gap towards someone on the other side. Its grammar is therefore already mirrored – structured by speaker and addressee, self and other, call and possible return.

Numerically it is written as a manufactured middle: $6+1 = 8-1$ – a ‘seven’ that only exists as construction, not as a clean step in the sequence. After this axis, the Black Figure’s presence begins to organise as a pattern the audience can feel and, for pattern-readers, eventually see. The mirror is deliberately imperfect. The design holds an ‘almost’ principle, with Scene 10 as the point where symmetry slips.

The broad pairings matter:

- **Scene 9 ↔ Scene 5:** the logic of the lost small being returns in adult form. Scene 5 ends on the abandoned ant-question, cut off mid-address; Scene 9 returns to that strandedness when the adult body fails to reset and the Black Figure first arrives clearly as co-regulating witness.
- **Scene 11 ↔ Scene 3:** panic and self-blame are mirrored by the brief possibility of harmony. Scene 3 is frantic search; Scene 11 is grounded stillness, parallel bodies, and a conditional interval before the system’s footsteps break it again.
- **Scene 13 ↔ Scene 1:** the origin material returns, but not solo. Scene 1 begins in grounded child-world logic, with reaching upwards and pulse-responses already hinting at waltz structure; Scene 13 returns to ‘I wrote a book’ with the Black Figure now moving into synchrony, so that the earlier solitary logic becomes shared.
- **Prologue ↔ Scene 14:** what is latent in sound becomes visible in bodies. The Prologue is already waltz-coded – breath-Chopin and underlying pulse – but the second body is not yet externalised. Scene 14 makes that hidden two-body structure visible, carrying the piece from internal rhythm to shared dance and support.

Scene 10 is the anomaly inside this mirror logic. Unlike 9, 11 and 13, it does not mirror a Maksio scene cleanly. That matters. It is a high-density system scene in which Masking M freezes under accumulated signals, and the Black Figure appears not as return to child-world but as the interruption the system-world itself has forced into visibility. The mirror slips exactly where the system can no longer contain its own pressure.

The fuller scene-by-scene geometry is mapped in the Scene Map. Here, the key point is that *Wołacz* is where number, grammar, Black Figure patterning and spectatorship all turn together. It is the counted hinge of the whole piece.

The Scene Map itself remains an internal document rather than a public guide. But the act of mapping has a possible afterlife beyond the performance: through a moderated “Just something I noticed” forum, audiences may later be invited to reconstruct parts of that geometry collectively, placing one pattern beside another and allowing the work’s structure to emerge through shared noticing rather than top-down explanation.

H. Later-number consequences

Once the 6–7–8 logic is established, later numbers begin to carry consequences rather than mere recurrence. They do not replace the governing cosmology; they show what happens when it develops under pressure.

10 is not only the number of Infinite Symphony, the scene where the mirror logic slips. It is also quietly preloaded in the Prologue field through 4+6: Maks Marzec and Mamo zobacz share the same count, so that the adult name already contains the earliest outward call. In that sense, 10 holds both mixed origin and anomaly: adult-plus-child arithmetic, then later system overload breaking pattern.

11 matters as prime mirroring and reconnection. In Scene 11, two bodies on the floor can read as doubled 1s – separate, singular, side by side – but the scene also belongs to the logic of 7 and healing. The number therefore carries more than one image at once: prime relation, parallel bodies, and the first real possibility that the split can generate harmony rather than only loss. Scene 11 is not a sentimental resolution, but it is the clearest point at which the abstraction of the missing middle returns to flesh as shared grounding.

12 behaves like a system-trap. It can be heard as 6+6, or as 4+8 / 8+4, depending on which earlier logics are being folded together. It is a number of coherence under pressure: a structure still able to count itself, but already close to clamping shut. This is why it sits so naturally near applause logic, where order, reward and pressure collapse into one another.

13 matters as return. In the piece it belongs most clearly to *Mantra*: the return to 'I wrote a book', not as simple repetition but as altered recurrence. Numerically it can be heard as 6+7 – origin carrying the missing middle inside itself – but dramaturgically its force is not just wounded continuation. It is the point at which return becomes possible without pretending the interruption never happened. The scene does not restore the beginning. It reaches it again carrying what the piece now knows.

14 intensifies the same pressure differently. As 7+7, it becomes doubled middle-work: not the clean passage through a lost centre, but a final state built out of repeated negotiation with what could not be crossed directly. This matters especially because the piece's end-state is haunted by Scene 11. The bodies there can read as 1s, but also as 7-shaped forms on the floor, so that the later logic of 14 holds both possibilities at once: doubled singularity and doubled healing-work. Fourteen therefore does not mean simple completion. It means integration assembled from repeated return to the site of rupture.

21 is the late reverse of 12. It acts as delayed completion, accumulated return, and re-framing rather than reset. This is one reason the final total of repeated 'Mamo' calls matters. The number is not simply reached. It is arrived at late, after suspension. What was once trap-like in 12 becomes re-ordered in 21: the same material, but under different terms.

72 is loaded duration. The Epilogue's 72 seconds of silence are not arbitrary. The number carries divisibility, extension and endurance under pressure. Unlike the primes, which resist division, 72 opens into many factors. It becomes a number of prolonged consequence: a duration the room must inhabit rather than decode.

7. APPENDIX: SCENE MAP

A quick reference for the scene sequence and naming logic.

#	Printed title	Letter count	World
P	PROLOGUE (FINALE) - P-R-A-W-I-E W-I-O-S-N-A = A-L-M-O-S-T S-P-R-I-N-G	8 (6) - 6 6 (6 6)	Stage assistants, Maks
1•/	SCENE 1 - C-H-M-U-R-Y (A-D-N-U-B-E-S)	6 (7)	Maksio
2•	SCENE 2 - C-R-O-W-D-I-N-G	8	Masking M
3•	SCENE 3 - W-I-O-S-N-A (A-M-I-S-S-U-M)	6 (7)	Maksio
4	SCENE 4 - T-A-X-O-N-O-M-Y	8	Masking M
5•	SCENE 5 - M-R-Ó-W-K-A (F-O-R-M-I-C-A)	6 (7)	Maksio
6	SCENE 6 - E-M-O-T-I-O-N-S	8	Masking M
6+1=8-1•	SCENE 6+1=8-1 - W-O-Ł-A-C-Z (V-O-C-A-T-I-V-E)	6 (8)	Maksio
8	SCENE 8 - C-L-I-M-B-I-N-G & S-L-I-P-P-I-N-G	8 8	Masking M
9	SCENE 9 - B-E-L-L A-N-O-M-AA-L-Y	4 8	Masking M + Black Figure
10	SCENE 10 - I-N-F-I-N-I-T-E S-Y-M-P-H-O-N-Y	8 8	Masking M + Black Figure later
1•1 ?	SCENE 1:1 - B-U-R-N-O-U-T & H-A-R-M-O-N-Y	7 7	Masking M + Black Figure
12	SCENE 12 - S-I-S-Y-P-H-U-S T-R-A-P	8 4	Masking M
13•	SCENE 13 - M-A-N-T-R-A	6	Masking M + Black Figure
14	SCENE 14 - 6-7-8	-	Masking M + Black Figure
E	EPILOGUE (OVERTURE) - I-N-F-I-N-I-T-E P-A-T-I-E-N-C-E	8 (8) - 8 8	Audience, Stage assistants

• black dot = prime number in the scene-list's underlying counting logic; red marks indicate correction, dispute or contamination introduced by the piece's corrective / system layer.

End of pack.